

Authorisation Forms (PHI Use/Disclosure)

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Purpose

This template is used to obtain a valid individual authorization before the organization uses or discloses Protected Health Information (PHI) for purposes that require explicit written permission, including but not limited to:

- Marketing communications where authorization is required.
- Research uses or disclosures not covered by another permitted pathway.
- Disclosures to third parties at the individual's request.
- Use or disclosure of psychotherapy notes, where applicable.
- Sale of PHI or disclosures involving remuneration, where applicable.
- Any use or disclosure of PHI not otherwise permitted by organizational policy or applicable privacy requirements.

This form is intended to ensure that authorizations are clear, specific, voluntary, documented, and revocable by the individual or their legally authorized representative.

Instructions

- **Use this form before the PHI is used or disclosed.** Do not process the requested use or disclosure until the authorization has been reviewed, signed, and approved according to the routing requirements below.
- **Complete all required fields.** An authorization is not valid if required information is missing, unclear, expired, or inconsistent.
- **Use plain language.** The individual must be able to understand what PHI will be used or disclosed, who will use or receive it, and for what purpose.
- **Describe the PHI specifically.** Avoid broad phrases such as “all records” unless the individual clearly intends to authorize release of the complete designated record set. Specify dates, departments, providers, record types, conditions, or service episodes where applicable.
- **Identify the recipient clearly.** If PHI will be disclosed to a person, organization, sponsor, researcher, vendor, media outlet, employer, school, attorney, insurer, or other third party, provide enough detail to identify the recipient.
- **State the purpose.** The form must describe the purpose of the use or disclosure. If the individual requests the authorization and does not wish to state a purpose, “At the request of the individual” may be used.
- **Include expiration.** Each authorization must include either a specific expiration date or a clear expiration event related to the purpose of the authorization.

- **Explain revocation rights.** The individual must be informed that they may revoke the authorization in writing, except to the extent the organization has already acted in reliance on it.
- **Explain potential redisclosure.** The individual must be informed that PHI disclosed under the authorization may be redisclosed by the recipient and may no longer be protected by the organization's privacy obligations.
- **Do not condition treatment, payment, enrollment, or eligibility on signing,** except where permitted by law and approved by the Privacy Officer.
- **Provide a copy to the individual.** A signed copy of the authorization must be offered or provided to the individual or their legally authorized representative.
- **Verify representative authority.** If signed by a personal representative, legal guardian, parent, executor, healthcare proxy, or other authorized party, confirm and document the basis of authority before processing.
- **Special review is required** for authorizations involving:
 - Marketing.
 - Research.
 - Psychotherapy notes.
 - Sale of PHI or disclosures involving payment or other value to the organization.
 - Minors' records.
 - Substance use disorder, reproductive health, genetic, mental health, HIV/AIDS, or other specially protected information.
 - Media, public relations, fundraising, employer, or law enforcement-related disclosures.
 - Requests involving large data sets or recurring disclosures.
- **Do not alter signed authorization language after signature.** If changes are required, obtain a new authorization.
- **File the completed authorization in the approved record location** and record the disclosure where required by organizational accounting and tracking processes.

Form Fields

Field	Type	Required	Guidance
Authorization Form Identifier	Text	Yes	Unique tracking number assigned by Privacy, HIM, Compliance, or the records system. Example: AUTH-[YYYY]-[Sequential Number].
Date Authorization Prepared	Date	Yes	Date the form is generated or prepared for signature.
Individual Full Legal Name	Text	Yes	Full name of the individual whose PHI is the subject of the authorization.
Individual Preferred Name	Text	No	Include if used by the organization to assist identification and communication.
Date of Birth	Date	Yes	Used to verify identity and match records accurately.
Medical Record Number / Patient ID	Text	Conditional	Required if the organization assigns a patient or member identifier.
Address	Text	Conditional	Required when needed for identity verification or mailing a copy.
Phone Number	Text	Conditional	Include if needed for follow-up or identity confirmation.

Field	Type	Required	Guidance
Email Address	Email	Conditional	Include only if email communication is requested or needed. Confirm secure communication preferences where applicable.
Identity Verified By	Dropdown / Text	Yes	Document verification method, such as government ID, patient portal authentication, existing registration verification, notarized request, or approved remote verification method.
Verification Date	Date	Yes	Date the identity or representative authority was verified.
Organization Authorized to Use or Disclose PHI	Text	Yes	Name the covered entity, department, clinic, provider group, health plan, business unit, or workforce area authorized to use or disclose PHI.
Specific Workforce Role or Department	Text	Conditional	Required if the authorization is limited to a particular department, researcher, treating provider, program, or business unit.
Recipient Name	Text	Yes	Name of the person or organization authorized to receive the PHI, if the authorization involves disclosure outside the organization.
Recipient Contact Person	Text	Conditional	Required where the recipient is an organization and a contact person is known.
Recipient Address	Text	Conditional	Required for mail, courier, legal, or formal disclosures.
Recipient Email	Email	Conditional	Required if disclosure will be made by email. Use only approved secure transmission methods unless the individual specifically requests otherwise after being informed of risks.
Recipient Phone Number	Text	Conditional	Include if needed to coordinate disclosure.
Recipient Fax Number	Text	Conditional	Required if disclosure will be made by fax. Confirm recipient fax number before sending.
Description of PHI to Be Used or Disclosed	Long Text	Yes	Describe the information specifically. Examples: lab results from [date range], discharge summary for [encounter], billing records for [date range], imaging reports, medication history, research data elements, marketing contact information.
Date Range of PHI	Date Range	Conditional	Required unless the authorization applies to a clearly defined event, episode, study, or record type.
Include Entire Medical Record	Checkbox	No	Use only if the individual specifically authorizes release of the complete record. Review for sensitive categories before release.
Sensitive Information Included	Checkbox Group	Conditional	Indicate if PHI includes specially sensitive information, such as mental health, substance use disorder, HIV/AIDS, genetic information, reproductive health, sexual health, minors' confidential services, or psychotherapy notes. Follow additional review requirements.
Psychotherapy Notes Included	Yes/No	Conditional	Required if psychotherapy notes are requested or implicated. This should generally be authorized separately from other PHI unless Privacy Officer approves the format.

Field	Type	Required	Guidance
Purpose of Use or Disclosure	Long Text	Yes	State the purpose clearly. Examples: participation in research study, marketing communication, disclosure to attorney, insurance review, school accommodation, personal request, media story, care coordination not otherwise permitted.
Purpose Category	Dropdown	Yes	Select one: Research, Marketing, Individual Request, Legal/Administrative, Media/Public Relations, Employer/School, Family/Personal Representative, Sale or Remunerated Disclosure, Other.
Marketing Involved	Yes/No	Yes	Select "Yes" if the PHI will be used to encourage purchase or use of a product or service and authorization is required.
Financial Remuneration Involved	Yes/No	Yes	Select "Yes" if the organization will receive direct or indirect payment or other value in exchange for the use or disclosure. Explain in the remuneration field.
Remuneration Description	Long Text	Conditional	Required if remuneration is involved. Describe the nature of payment or value in plain language.
Sale of PHI Involved	Yes/No	Yes	Select "Yes" if PHI will be exchanged for payment or other value in a manner requiring explicit authorization. Requires Privacy Officer and Legal review.
Research Study Name	Text	Conditional	Required for research authorizations. Use the protocol title or public-facing study name.
Research Principal Investigator	Text	Conditional	Required for research authorizations.
Research Sponsor	Text	Conditional	Required if the study is sponsored or funded by an external party.
Research Data Use Description	Long Text	Conditional	Required for research authorizations. Describe how PHI will be used, who will access it, and whether identifiable information will leave the organization.
Authorization Combined With Consent or Other Permission	Yes/No	Yes	Indicate whether this authorization is combined with another form, such as research consent. Combined forms must be reviewed for clarity and voluntariness.
Redisclosure Warning Provided	Checkbox	Yes	Confirm the individual has been informed that information disclosed to the recipient may be redisclosed and may no longer be protected by the organization.
Right to Revoke Explained	Checkbox	Yes	Confirm the individual has been informed of their right to revoke the authorization in writing.
Revocation Submission Method	Text	Yes	Provide where and how revocation must be submitted, such as Privacy Office address, patient portal, approved email address, or HIM department.
Effect of Revocation Explained	Checkbox	Yes	Confirm the individual has been informed that revocation will not affect actions already taken in reliance on the authorization.
Conditioning Statement Included	Checkbox	Yes	Confirm the form states whether treatment, payment, enrollment, or eligibility is conditioned on signing and, if so, describes the permitted reason.

Field	Type	Required	Guidance
Is Signing Required to Receive Treatment, Payment, Enrollment, or Benefits?	Yes/No	Yes	Must generally be "No" unless approved by Privacy Officer and Legal. If "Yes," explain below.
Conditioning Explanation	Long Text	Conditional	Required if signing is a condition for a permitted activity, such as research-related treatment or eligibility for a service that requires the disclosure.
Expiration Date	Date	Conditional	Required unless an expiration event is used. Must be specific and reasonable for the stated purpose.
Expiration Event	Text	Conditional	Required if no expiration date is used. Example: end of research study, conclusion of legal matter, completion of requested disclosure, termination of participation in [program].
One-Time Disclosure or Ongoing Authorization	Dropdown	Yes	Select one-time, recurring, continuous for defined period, or event-based.
Frequency of Disclosure	Text	Conditional	Required for recurring or ongoing authorizations. Example: monthly, each visit, upon update, at study milestones.
Disclosure Method	Checkbox Group	Conditional	Select applicable method: secure portal, encrypted email, mail, fax, secure file transfer, verbal disclosure, in-person pickup, API/electronic exchange, other approved method.
Individual Requests Insecure Transmission	Yes/No	Conditional	Required if individual requests email or another method that may not be secure. Document risk warning and confirmation.
Risk Warning for Insecure Transmission Provided	Checkbox	Conditional	Required where applicable. Confirm the individual was informed of risks and still requested the method.
Minimum Necessary Review Completed	Yes/No	Conditional	Required for workforce processing. Confirm the disclosure is limited to the PHI authorized and appropriate for the purpose.
Fees Disclosed, If Applicable	Yes/No/Not Applicable	Conditional	Indicate whether any permissible copying, media, or processing fee was disclosed to the individual before fulfillment.
Individual Signature	Signature	Yes	Signature of the individual whose PHI is being used or disclosed, unless signed by a verified personal representative.
Individual Signature Date	Date	Yes	Date the individual signs the authorization. The authorization is not valid without a signature date.
Personal Representative Name	Text	Conditional	Required if signed by someone other than the individual.
Personal Representative Relationship	Text	Conditional	Examples: parent, legal guardian, healthcare proxy, executor, power of attorney, court-appointed representative.
Authority Documentation Reviewed	Checkbox	Conditional	Required if signed by a personal representative. Confirm supporting authority was reviewed.
Description of Authority	Long Text	Conditional	Describe the document or basis of authority reviewed, such as court order, guardianship document, power of attorney, healthcare proxy, estate appointment, parental authority, or other recognized authority.
Personal Representative Signature	Signature	Conditional	Required if the individual does not sign personally.
Personal Representative Signature Date	Date	Conditional	Required if representative signs.

Field	Type	Required	Guidance
Witness Name	Text	Conditional	Required if organizational policy, state law, research protocol, or high-risk disclosure review requires witness documentation.
Witness Signature	Signature	Conditional	Required where witness is used.
Witness Signature Date	Date	Conditional	Required where witness is used.
Interpreter Used	Yes/No	Conditional	Required if interpretation was provided.
Interpreter Name or ID	Text	Conditional	Required if interpreter used.
Language Provided	Text	Conditional	Required if form was translated or interpreted.
Copy Provided to Individual	Yes/No	Yes	Confirm whether a copy of the signed authorization was provided or offered.
Copy Delivery Method	Dropdown / Text	Conditional	Required if copy was provided. Examples: paper copy, secure portal, encrypted email, mail.
Staff Member Receiving Authorization	Text	Yes	Name or ID of workforce member who received the completed form.
Department Receiving Authorization	Text	Yes	Department responsible for intake, such as HIM, Privacy Office, Research Office, Patient Access, Marketing, or clinic.
Intake Date	Date	Yes	Date completed authorization was received by the organization.
Privacy Review Required	Yes/No	Yes	Select "Yes" for high-risk or special categories identified in the instructions.
Privacy Review Decision	Dropdown	Conditional	Required when Privacy review is required. Select approved, approved with conditions, rejected, or returned for correction.
Privacy Review Notes	Long Text	Conditional	Document review rationale, restrictions, required safeguards, or reasons for rejection.
Legal Review Required	Yes/No	Conditional	Required for sale of PHI, remuneration, complex research, litigation-related disclosures, media, minors' rights conflicts, or other high-risk matters.
Legal Review Decision	Dropdown	Conditional	Required when Legal review is required.
Fulfillment Approved By	Text	Conditional	Name or role approving the use or disclosure after validation.
Fulfillment Date	Date	Conditional	Date PHI was used or disclosed.
Disclosure Logged	Yes/No/Not Applicable	Conditional	Confirm whether the disclosure was recorded in the accounting or disclosure tracking process, where required.
Disclosure Log Reference	Text	Conditional	Link or identifier for the disclosure accounting record, if applicable.
Revocation Received	Yes/No	Conditional	Update if the individual later revokes the authorization.
Revocation Date	Date	Conditional	Required if revocation is received.
Revocation Processed By	Text	Conditional	Workforce member or department that processed the revocation.
Actions Stopped After Revocation	Long Text	Conditional	Describe future uses or disclosures stopped because of revocation.
Reliance Actions Already Completed	Long Text	Conditional	Document any actions already taken before revocation that cannot be reversed.
Record Location	Text	Yes	Approved system or repository where the authorization and related documentation are stored.

Field	Type	Required	Guidance
Retention Trigger Date	Date	Yes	Usually the signature date, expiration date, fulfillment date, or date last relied upon, as determined by retention policy.

Approval / Routing

Completed authorizations must follow the routing below before PHI is used or disclosed.

Scenario	Required Review / Approval	Routing Destination	Key Review Points
Routine individual-directed disclosure to a third party	HIM or authorized records team	Health Information Management / Records Release	Identity verification, recipient details, PHI description, expiration, signature, secure delivery method.
Marketing use or disclosure requiring authorization	Privacy Officer and Marketing Owner	Privacy Office, then Marketing Department	Required authorization language, remuneration disclosure if applicable, opt-out coordination, recipient controls, campaign scope.
Research use or disclosure	Research Office, Privacy Officer, and study leadership	Research Administration / Privacy Office	Study purpose, data elements, participant authorization, sponsor access, combined consent clarity, revocation handling.
Psychotherapy notes	Privacy Officer and appropriate clinical leadership	Privacy Office	Separate authorization, sensitive content handling, recipient need, legal restrictions, clinical risk considerations.
Sale of PHI or disclosure involving remuneration	Privacy Officer and Legal Counsel	Privacy Office and Legal	Explicit disclosure of remuneration, permissibility, contract terms, individual understanding, reputational and compliance risk.
Media, public relations, or testimonial	Privacy Officer, Legal Counsel, and Communications Lead	Privacy Office / Legal / Communications	Scope of PHI, images or recordings, publicity duration, withdrawal limits, future use, third-party platforms.
Minor's record or personal representative signature	Privacy Officer or designated specialist	Privacy Office / HIM	Authority to sign, minor consent rights, sensitive services, custody or guardianship restrictions.
Specially protected information	Privacy Officer and Legal Counsel where needed	Privacy Office	Additional confidentiality obligations, segmentation, express inclusion, recipient limitations.
Employer, school, attorney, insurer, or administrative request	HIM or Privacy Officer depending on risk	HIM / Privacy Office	Voluntariness, specific recipient, date range, purpose, potential coercion, minimum necessary fulfillment.
Unsecure transmission requested by individual	HIM or Privacy Officer if high risk	HIM / Privacy Office	Risk warning provided, individual direction documented, correct recipient, transmission method.
Revocation of authorization	Privacy Officer or designated records team	Privacy Office / HIM / Relevant Department	Written revocation, identity verification, stop future uses/disclosures, notify affected teams, document reliance actions.

Approval must be documented before fulfillment for any authorization requiring Privacy, Legal, Research, Marketing, Communications, or clinical leadership review.

A submitted authorization must be rejected or returned for correction if any of the following apply:

- The form is unsigned or undated.
- The individual or representative cannot be verified.
- Representative authority is not established.
- The PHI description is missing, vague, or inconsistent with the purpose.
- The recipient is not identifiable.

- The purpose is missing or unclear.
- No expiration date or expiration event is provided.
- Required statements about revocation, conditioning, or redisclosure are missing.
- The authorization has expired.
- The authorization is known to have been revoked.
- Material information is false or incomplete.
- Required special review has not been completed.
- The requested use or disclosure is not permitted by organizational policy or applicable law.

Records & Retention

Completed authorizations and related review records must be retained as official privacy documentation.

Record	Owner	Storage Location	Retention Requirement	Notes
Signed authorization form	Privacy Officer / HIM	[Approved Records System]	Retain for at least six years from the date last in effect or longer if required by organizational retention schedule	Must be retrievable for audit, complaint investigation, and disclosure verification.
Identity verification evidence or notation	HIM / Intake Department	[Approved Records System]	Retain with the authorization record	Do not store unnecessary copies of identity documents unless required by policy.
Personal representative authority documentation	HIM / Privacy Office	[Approved Records System]	Retain with the authorization record	Include enough documentation to support authority to sign.
Privacy review notes and decision	Privacy Office	[Privacy Case Management System]	Retain for at least six years from decision date or longer if tied to the authorization record	Required for high-risk, sensitive, or escalated authorizations.
Legal review notes and decision	Legal Department	[Legal Matter System]	Retain according to legal record retention requirements	Cross-reference authorization identifier where appropriate.
Research authorization review documentation	Research Office	[Research Administration System]	Retain according to study and organizational retention requirements	Must align with study documentation and participant records.
Disclosure accounting entry, where applicable	HIM / Privacy Office	[Disclosure Tracking System]	Retain according to privacy accounting retention requirements	Include date, recipient, PHI disclosed, purpose, and authorization reference.
Revocation request	Privacy Office / HIM	[Approved Records System]	Retain with original authorization	Must include date received, validation, actions stopped, and reliance actions already completed.
Transmission confirmation	Fulfillment Department	[Approved Records System]	Retain with fulfillment record	Examples: fax confirmation, secure portal delivery receipt, certified mail tracking, secure transfer log.
Rejected or invalid authorization	Privacy Office / HIM	[Approved Records System]	Retain according to privacy documentation retention requirements	Record reason for rejection and any communication to requester.

Access to authorization records must be limited to workforce members with a business need, such as Privacy, HIM, Legal, Research Administration, Compliance, and authorized department personnel.

Authorization records must be protected against unauthorized access, alteration, deletion, and disclosure. Electronic records must be stored in approved systems with access controls, audit logging, backup, and retention controls. Paper records must be stored in secure areas and scanned or filed according to organizational records management procedures.

If an authorization is revoked, the organization must promptly document the revocation, notify departments that may rely on the authorization, stop future uses or disclosures covered by the revocation, and retain evidence of any actions already taken before the revocation was received and processed.